

STARTER

Field-by-Field Online Application Walkthrough

Australia - Student Visa (Subclass 500)

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

Before you start

The Student visa (subclass 500) is applied for online through an ImmiAccount at the Department of Home Affairs. It's decided under the Migration Act 1958 and Migration Regulations 1994 by a departmental case officer. Gather the following before you begin:

- Your Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE), issued by your education provider once you've accepted an offer and (usually) paid any required deposit - your course must be on CRICOS, the Commonwealth Register of Institutions and Courses for Overseas Students
- Valid passport or other travel document
- Evidence of your English language ability, if required for your course and not already confirmed by your provider
- Financial evidence meeting the published cost-of-living formula - see the Financial Requirements Overview (Essential tier)
- Overseas Student Health Cover (OSHC), arranged for your entire intended stay
- A statement addressing the Genuine Student requirement

CRICOS AND YOUR CoE COME FIRST

Your education provider issues your CoE only once you've accepted an offer for a CRICOS-registered course. Every field on your application relating to your course must match your CoE exactly - provider name, course details, and your own passport and personal details. Mismatches are a common, avoidable cause of delay or refusal; see the Refusal Reasons guide.

Section-by-section

1. Personal details

Name, date of birth, nationality, and passport details exactly as they appear in your passport - and exactly as they were given to your provider when your CoE was issued.

2. Your CoE and course details

- Enter your CoE details exactly as issued - provider, course, and start/end dates
- If you're under 18 at the time of application, welfare arrangements (guardianship or approved accommodation) apply - check your specific requirement

3. The Genuine Student requirement

You'll need to satisfy the case officer that you're a genuine student - addressing your reasons for choosing this course and provider, your understanding of the course, your circumstances at home, and your intentions after you finish. The framing and exact name of this requirement has been updated in recent policy changes, so confirm the current specific wording and questions on the department's website before you apply.

4. Financial requirement

You'll declare how you're funding your course fees and living costs, and provide supporting evidence against the published formula - see the Financial Requirements Overview and the Financial Planning Calculator (Premium tier).

5. Overseas Student Health Cover (OSHC)

You must arrange OSHC covering your entire intended stay before or as part of your application - this is a mandatory, checked requirement, not a recommendation.

6. Background and character

Previous visas, visits, refusals, and any immigration violations - answer completely. Standard character and, depending on your circumstances, health declarations also apply.

7. Pay the visa application charge

The Visa Application Charge (VAC) is paid online as part of submission and is generally non-refundable, whether or not your visa is granted.

8. Submit supporting documents

Upload your CoE, OSHC policy details, financial evidence, and Genuine Student statement. The department may request further information if something needs clarifying - respond by the stated deadline if this happens.